

Phantom Studio AI

Luxury ad campaigns with no camera, no models, no studio — just a laptop.

What It Is

Phantom Studio AI is a done-for-you content agency that produces premium product photography, fashion-runway visuals, and short ad campaigns entirely with AI image and video tools (Fancy AI and similar). Brands get the look of a \$10,000 photoshoot — real-looking models, locations, and backstage moments — without booking a single shoot. You sell the output (finished images and video ads), not the software.

How It Makes Money

You charge brands per campaign or on a monthly content retainer. The model is pure service arbitrage: AI tools cost you tens of dollars a month, and you sell the finished creative for hundreds to thousands per deliverable. Buyers are e-commerce stores, fashion and beauty brands, supplement and skincare companies, jewelry sellers, real estate stagers, and local boutiques — anyone who needs a constant flow of scroll-stopping visuals but can't justify studio costs.

Startup Costs

- Fancy AI / generative image + video subscriptions: \$40-\$120/month (start on a mid tier, scale credits as orders come in)
- Upscaler + face/product consistency tools (Magnific, Topaz, or built-in): \$25-\$50/month
- Video editing (CapCut Pro / Premiere): \$0-\$23/month
- Laptop capable of running browser AI tools: \$0 if owned, \$700-\$1,200 if buying
- Portfolio site + logo (Coolify-hosted): \$0-\$100
- Cold outreach tools (email finder + sender): \$30-\$80/month
- Total realistic startup: **\$150-\$500** to be live and selling

This is a service, so there's no inventory or China sourcing — your only "stock" is AI generation credits.

The Numbers

- Cost per campaign delivered (credits + your time): ~\$30-\$60 in tool credits
- Sell price: \$400-\$1,500 per campaign (10-20 images + 1-3 short video ads)
- Profit per campaign: roughly **\$350-\$1,400**
- Monthly projection: land 6 clients on a \$600/month retainer = \$3,600/month revenue against ~~\$250 in tool costs~~ = ****\$3,300/month profit****, scaling to \$8,000-\$12,000/month once you're delivering 12-15 retainers and can charge premium "fashion campaign" rates.

How To Start

1. Pick a niche you'll dominate first — fashion/apparel or beauty convert fastest because visuals are everything.
2. Master one workflow in Fancy AI: upload a product, generate consistent on-model and lifestyle shots, then animate the best frames into 5-10 second ad clips.
3. Build a portfolio by creating 3 fake "case study" campaigns for imaginary brands so prospects can see the quality.

4. Set three packages: Starter (10 images, \$400), Growth (20 images + 2 video ads, \$800), Campaign (full runway-style drop, \$1,500).
5. Cold-DM and email 20 brands a day on Instagram and Shopify directories; lead with a free sample image of THEIR actual product.
6. Deliver fast (24-48 hours), collect a testimonial, and convert one-off buyers to monthly retainers.
7. Reinvest first profits into better upscaling and a small ad spend to inbound leads.

Where To Get Customers

- Instagram and TikTok DMs to brands already running paid ads (they have budget and need fresh creative)
- Shopify and Etsy store directories — filter for sellers with weak product photos
- Upwork and Fiverr to capture inbound "AI product photography" search demand
- Local boutiques, salons, and jewelers via in-person walk-ins with a printed sample
- Facebook groups for e-commerce founders and dropshippers
- Post your own AI campaigns as content — the "this isn't real" hook sells the service for you

Pro Tips

- Always lead outreach with a free generated sample of the prospect's own product — the "wow, that's MY item" moment closes deals faster than any pitch.
- Sell outcomes, not AI: brands don't care that it's AI, they care about higher click-through and lower cost per shoot. Frame pricing against the \$5,000+ they'd pay a real studio.
- Lock in retainers by offering "X new visuals every month" — recurring revenue beats chasing one-off gigs, and brands always need fresh creative for new drops and seasons.